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China Coal | Asia Pacific

Weekly Coal Update: Coal Production Declined Seasonally in May

Key Takeaways

- Thermal coal and coking coal prices both trended up WoW.

Thermal coal price recovery continued:

- QHD 5500 inched up 0.3% WoW, to Rmb715/t as of May 15.
- BSPI edged up 0.3% WoW, to Rmb704/t.
- CCI 5500 increased 1.3% WoW, to Rmb835/t.
- Mine-mouth prices for Shanxi Datong 5800 rose 2.9% WoW, to Rmb705/t.

Seaborne prices declined: NEWC price fell 1.5% WoW.

Domestic coking coal prices trended up mostly:

- Liulin No. 4 mine-mouth prices rose 2.9% WoW, to Rmb710/t...
- ...while FOR prices rose 1.9% WoW, to Rmb1,640/t.
- QLD prices dipped 0.4% WoW, to US\$239/t.

Chart of the week – May coal production showed seasonal decline:

Coal production was down 1% YoY and down 12.5% MoM in April 2026, to 386mnt. The MoM drop in coal volume mainly reflected seasonal decline, as the winter heating season ended in March. Total coal production is up 1.2% YoY YTD.

We remain optimistic about summer demand. Despite substitution pressure from renewables, seasonal cooling demand is likely to drive higher thermal power generation. According to Sxcoal, coal inventories at major coastal and inland power plants hovered at relatively low levels as of May 14, 0.5-2.9% less than in the same period last year. The approaching summer peak offers additional support to thermal coal prices.

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CHINA COAL

Asia Pacific

Industry View

Cautious

Exhibit 2 : Data for the week

		15-May	WoW	YTD	YTD avg	'25 avg	YTD vs '25
Regional							
NEWC thermal coal	US\$/ton	130	-1.5%	19.3%	124	106.6	16.6%
QLD coking coal	US\$/ton	239	-0.4%	9.6%	231	189.0	22.4%
China							
QHD 5500 kcal/kg	Rmb/ton	715	0.3%	2.9%	695	684	1.5%
CCI 5500 kcal/kg	Rmb/ton	835	1.3%	22.4%	743	864	-14.0%
BSPI	Rmb/ton	704	0.3%	1.3%	690	682	1.1%
Liulin No. 4 mine-mouth	Rmb/ton	710	2.9%	6.0%	686	641	7.0%
Liulin No. 4 FOR	Rmb/ton	1,640	1.9%	3.8%	1,567	1,399	12.1%
QHD Inventory	mt	5.92	1.0%	-15.1%	5.97	6.37	-6.3%

Note: QLD = Queensland; QHD = Qinhuangdao; CCI = China Coal Index; BSPI = Bohai-Rim Steam-Coal Price Index; FOR = Free on Rail. Source: China Coal Transport and Distribution Association (CCTD), McCloskeys, Morgan Stanley Research.

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Exhibit 1: Chart of the week – China: Monthly Coal Production



Source: Sxcoal, Morgan Stanley Research.

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	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
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Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	0	0%	0%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	555	15%	84	9%	15%	202	12%
Total	3,673		909			1627	

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COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (05/18/2026)
Hannah Yang, CFA		
China Coal Energy Co., Ltd. (601898.SS)	E (03/16/2026)	Rmb17.41
China Coal Energy Co., Ltd. (1898.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$12.99
China Shenhua Energy (1088.HK)	O (11/02/2017)	HK\$44.92
China Shenhua Energy (601088.SS)	E (04/04/2019)	Rmb45.85
Shaanxi Coal Industry (601225.SS)	O (03/16/2026)	Rmb24.39
Shanxi Coking Coal (000983.SZ)	E (10/26/2021)	Rmb6.70
Yancoal Australia Ltd (3668.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$37.30
Yankuang Energy Group Co Ltd (1171.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$14.93
Yankuang Energy Group Co Ltd (600188.SS)	E (03/16/2026)	Rmb22.04
Rachel L Zhang		
Shougang Fushan Resources Group Limited (0639.HK)	O (09/15/2022)	HK\$2.60

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